

Circular 2025/07 — Open Banking API Standards — New Mandatory Implementation Requirements

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Effective Date:	01 October 2025	Response Deadline:	31 July 2025
Issuing Authority:	Financial Regulatory Authority	Classification:	MANDATORY

1. Introduction

The Authority is introducing mandatory Open Banking requirements for all licensed retail banks and payment service providers. This circular establishes binding technical standards for the implementation of Open Banking APIs, customer consent management and third-party provider (TPP) access controls. These are entirely new obligations with no predecessor circular — all requirements must be treated as new implementation mandates.

2. Mandatory API Standards

All in-scope firms must implement Open Banking APIs conforming to the Financial-grade API (FAPI) 2.0 security profile by 1 October 2025. The following APIs are mandatory: (a) Account Information Service (AIS) — read access to account balances and transactions; (b) Payment Initiation Service (PIS) — initiation of domestic and international payments; (c) Confirmation of Funds (CoF) — real-time balance confirmation for TPPs; (d) Event Notification API — webhook-based notifications for account events. APIs must maintain 99.5% uptime SLA and respond within 1,500ms for 95% of requests.

3. Customer Consent Framework

Firms must implement a granular consent management system allowing customers to: grant, modify and revoke TPP access at the account level; view a complete history of all TPP data access events; set expiry dates on consent grants (maximum 90 days renewable); receive real-time notifications of TPP access. Consent records must be retained for 7 years and made available to customers on request within 1 business day.

4. Third-Party Provider Onboarding

Firms must implement an automated TPP onboarding process that validates TPP registration status with the Authority's TPP registry in real time. Access must be refused to any TPP whose registration is suspended or revoked. Firms must conduct quarterly reviews of all active TPP connections and immediately revoke access for non-compliant TPPs.

5. Testing and Certification

All firms must complete conformance testing against the Authority's Open Banking test suite by 31 July 2025 and obtain a Conformance Certificate prior to go-live. Firms failing conformance testing by the deadline must submit a remediation plan within 10 business days. The Authority will publish the test suite on its developer portal by 1 April 2025.